

Dual-port RAM

Dual-port RAM gives two independent access ports, address, write enable, and data in, sharing one memory array

Independent ports starter

- Starter: eight-by-eight RAM with write-first policy
- Port A at address zero, port B at address one, no collision
- Step clock to read both ports independently
- Then preset W slash W collision
- Or preset W slash R: port A writes while port B reads
- Under write-first, B sees new data

Browser lab

Digital Design and Verification Platform

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INTERACTIVE TOOL

Dual-port RAM

Two independent ports on one array — step both, then poke **same-address** collisions (W/W, W/R).

Starter example: 8×8 RAM, ports on different addresses — then force a same-address collision and compare policies.

Load starter example

Challenges (1/22)

Quiz: dual. RAM with two independent access ports is? Answer: dual-port

Answer

Show hint

Check

Next

Idle

quiz-dual

quiz-collide

quiz-wf

quiz-rf

starter

step

indep

preset-ww

preset-wr

step-ww

step-wr-wf

step-wr-rf

dont-care

policy-wf

policy-sel

clear

demo

explain

code-we

write-cell

rr-ok

full-path

Core ideas

Two ports

Independent addr / we / din — one shared array.

Collision

Same address + a write → policy decides dout / final data.

Policies

write-first, read-first, or don't-care (X).

Dual-port RAM starter

Workbook practice

- On paper, draw an eight-word RAM with two ports
- Trace independent reads at addr zero and three
- Tabulate collision cases: W slash W, W slash R, R slash R same address
- For W slash R with write-first, note whether the read port sees old or new data
- Name one pitfall: assuming all BRAMs behave the same on collision

Pitfalls to watch

- Do not ignore same-address writes
- Read-first versus write-first changes W slash R behavior on the read port
- R slash R at the same address is fine, both see the same cell
- And remember

Your turn

- Complete the checklist for at least one track, preferably both
- In the browser, step independent ports, then collide with two policies
- On paper, sketch one W slash R timing with read-first
- When you are ready, take the short quiz, then continue to byte-enable memory